

ALAN PONTON

UX / Product Designer · Designs and Ships

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SUMMARY

Product-minded UX designer who owns the full arc — research framing, information architecture, interaction and visual design, content and conversation design, accessibility — and ships the production build. I design for real users under real constraints, put the work in front of them, and iterate. Two end-to-end case studies carry the story: a productized travel platform built under severe constraint, and a security-operations tool taken through three documented versions including a self-correction reversing my own work in users' favor. Google UX Design and Meta Front-End certified. AI-augmented development is my force multiplier: it lets one designer carry an idea from research to a live, maintained product.

SELECTED DESIGN WORK

Lonnie's Locations — Productized Group-Travel Platform · UX Designer & Full-Stack Developer (solo) *Dec 2025 – Present*

End-to-end product design and build for an independent travel advisor with a thriving high-touch business and zero digital infrastructure. Live in production serving real guests.

- Mined the advisor's inbox as a qualitative dataset (no research budget) to derive the recurring question taxonomy that became the AI knowledge base and FAQ architecture.
- Caught and reversed my own designer-imposition failure — had designed an aspirational itinerary over the client's actual chosen plans — and made “design for who the user is, not who I assume they should be” a governing principle.
- Designed an AI travel concierge as a conversation-design problem first: trip-aware persona, suggested-question chips to lower the blank-prompt barrier, streaming for perceived performance, and deliberate refusal boundaries on pricing, medical, and refund questions.
- Identified the human-escalation banner as a trust-integrity defect (it promised a follow-up the system never sent) and designed the closed loop: real-time admin dashboard, color-coded urgency, transcript context, proactive contact capture.
- Designed structurally distinct reservation flows matched to each trip's mental model, plus a passwordless guest portal with status microcopy that converts database states into emotional reassurance. Accessibility treated as a premium feature for an older, mobile-first audience.

2100 Security — Security Operations Platform · UX Designer & Full-Stack Developer (solo) *2024 – Present*

A progressive web app I designed and built for the five-person overnight security team I work with at a 33-floor Dallas high-rise. Replaced a broken no-SSL legacy site; evolved across three production versions, in nightly use.

- Derived design constraints from direct observation of officers using the old site in real conditions — low light, one-handed, mid-patrol — turning friction points into hard requirements (dark-by-default, high-contrast, no horizontal scroll).
- V1 → V2 self-correction: my own visually-impressive dark theme tested as unreadable on a long shift; I reversed it, stripping styling back and prioritizing readability over aesthetics based on user feedback.
- Designed the access model around a governing principle drawn from a failed chat-tool rollout (“zero-friction access beats feature richness”): a passwordless guard-picker identity layer — no email, no app store, under five seconds.
- Inverse design judgment: deliberately added friction — employee-ID re-entry to confirm fire-extinguisher inspections — because a careless tap on a safety record is real-world harm, not a UI annoyance.
- Constraint-based scheduling engine honoring 5–7 simultaneous rules; rebuilt the data architecture after a decoupling bug, adopting incremental single-transformation validation as a method.

Additional Shipped Products · Solo, AI-augmented

2025 – Present

- MetroPlex Match — compatibility-first dating platform (205+ users); product framing of “optimize for compatibility, not swipes.”
- Trip Buddy — AI travel companion with a modular wardrobe/outfit system and voice concierge; built over 14 sessions and used personally on a real cruise.
- Push Coach — SMS accountability coaching; FollowThisModel — AI-twin communication platform with beta users; Sophia AI — the voice-first assistant foundation behind several products.

CAPABILITIES

Design User research framing, information architecture, interaction & visual design, conversation/AI UX design, content strategy & microcopy, accessibility (WCAG, reduced-motion), wireframing, prototyping, usability iteration

Build React, TypeScript, Tailwind, Framer Motion; Supabase (schema & RLS), n8n automation, Cloudflare (Pages/DNS/Workers); AI integration (Anthropic Claude API, OpenAI, agent/tool design); Figma; Git

Approach Constraint-driven product design, AI-augmented full-stack delivery, ship-measure-iterate

CREDENTIALS & EXPERIENCE

- **Google UX Design Professional Certificate** · Coursera, 2022
- **Meta Front-End Developer Professional Certificate** · Coursera, 2024
- In progress: IBM AI Engineering · Microsoft AI-900 · AWS credentials
- **Network Administrator, State of New Jersey** · 2005–2019 · 14+ years enterprise/government IT and infrastructure
- **Application Developer, Experian (Fortune 500)** · 1998–2003 · enterprise data-processing systems